Ashfaqullah Khan made it quite clear that India should not substitute one form of oppressive rule with another by gaining Independence:

> I consider alien rule an evil, and at the same time I hate any democratic Indian rule where the weak are denied rights, [if] it is the creation of the rich and the landed, or if there is no equal participation of farmers and workers, or if government laws are based on inequality and unequal treatment . . .[9]

The recognition of this alternative tradition of the revolutionaries is more important today than it ever was given the politics of the entire subcontinent. We have forgotten that precisely at the time when the RSS was being organized in 1925 in Nagpur, Bhagat Singh and his comrades were founding the Naujawan Bharat Sabha in Lahore in 1926. One stood for division and the other for unity. One was based on religion and the other on secularism. We should therefore not forget this period when 'Bhagat Singh was acutely conscious of the growing menace of communalism in the 1920s', because this was after all 'the decade which saw the emergence of the *Hindu Mahasabah* and the *Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh* (RSS)' but where there were also 'specific movements of the Muslims like *Tablighi Jamaat*'. 'Bhagat Singh questioned the policy of encouraging competing communalisms, which ultimately led to the partition of the country in 1947.'[10] Such was the significance of this alternative approach to India's freedom struggle which eschewed Gandhian non-violence, that among the cases, the government prosecuted not only the Kakori Train Dacoity Case, but also other cases like the Deoghar Conspiracy Case, Cawnpore Conspiracy Case, Meerut Conspiracy Trials and the Lahore Conspiracy Case.[11] Of these it was the latter which was the most significant.

It was colonialism's 'civilising mission' that gave rise to this alternative tradition, and this is another reason why the revolutionary tradition needs to be memorialized. This is the tradition of 'sarfaroshi' and of self-sacrifice. It came about in Bhagat Singh's life because he was a witness to a number of violent colonial events. He was only eight years old when the executions in the First Lahore Conspiracy Case took place. These consisted of no less than nine cases, which arose after the failed Ghadar Conspiracy from 26